Executive Order 9066

President Franklin D. Roosevelt · February 19, 1942

Source: Executive Order 9066 (1942). Public domain. The operative authorization.

> This order authorized the military to designate “military areas” from which “any or all persons may be excluded” — the legal basis for forcibly removing over 110,000 Japanese Americans to incarceration camps during World War II.

Now, Therefore, by virtue of the authority vested in me as President of the United States, and Commander in Chief of the Army and Navy, I hereby authorize and direct the Secretary of War, and the Military Commanders whom he may from time to time designate, whenever he or any designated Commander deem such action necessary or desirable to prescribe military areas in such places and of such extent as he or the appropriate Military Commander may determine, from which any or all persons may be excluded, and with respect to which, the right of any person to enter, remain in, or leave shall be subject to whatever restriction the Secretary of War or the appropriate Military Commander may impose in his discretion.